



SPANISH

THE KINGDOM OF SPAIN was formed in 1492, when King Ferdinand and Queen Isabella united the kingdoms of Castilla and Aragón and made Roman Catholicism the national religion. Today, Spain has 17 regions

A NATION ON THE IBERIAN PENINSULA

Old traditions, current passions

Many aspects of Spanish culture have evolved out of traditional folk customs, yet it is Roman Catholicism that has had the greatest impact on Spanish culture. Over 3,000 religious festivals—ancient and modern, local and national—are celebrated throughout the country.

CAPITAL CITY

Madrid sits in the very center of the country. Of the many modern buildings in the city, none are more immediately striking than these leaning office blocks in the Plaza de Castilla.



FERIA DE ABRIL

Men dressed as Andalusian peasants ride horses and carts through the streets during Seville's annual fair. Hundreds of tents house temporary dance halls during the week-long festival that attracts one million people.

SPANISH SNACKS

Every bar in Spain serves *tapas*, small plates of snacks to go with drinks. Originally free, these days they must be paid for. Typical *tapas* might be Spanish omelet, cured ham, squid, shrimp, olives, potatoes, or anchovies. Spanish people sometimes spend an evening going from bar to bar sampling each one's speciality dish.

